1951

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FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

5

FJ1022/595

FROM
Chancery,
British Embassy,
Tokyo.

No. 119/383/51

Dated 12th June, 1951.

Received in Registry— 19th June, 1951.

Disposal of Sakhalin and Kaita-to.

REFERENCES

FJ1022/316
FJ 10114/5.

MINUTES

The phrase "and islands adjacent to" south Sakhalin appears to be in order.

R.S. Milward
20/6

C.H. Scott 20/6

Mr. Fitzmaurice

Northern Dept. 26/6

C.A.S.
25.vi.

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)

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United Kingdom Liaison Mission
in Japan,
British Embassy,
Tokyo.

6

12th June, 1951

RESTRICTED
119/383/51

FJ 1022/595

Dear Department,

Please refer to para. 2 of Johnston's letter to the Charge d'Affaires No. FJ 1022/316 of the 23rd May about the formula contained in paragraph 2(a) of the Livadia Agreement that:- "The southern part of Sakhalin as well as all the islands adjacent to it shall be returned to the Soviet Union".

2. We were not until recently aware that this phrase, whose exact meaning had hitherto troubled us, was word for word the same as that used in the Russo-Japanese Treaty of Portsmouth of 1905. We presume, therefore, that is the reason why it was used in the 1945 Livadia Agreement where, perhaps, it was put forward by the Soviet delegation.

FJ1011 4/5

3. We agree with Research Department's comment on the island of KAIBA-TO (sometimes called Totomosiri island) which, as stated at paragraph 19 of the memorandum enclosed in Clutton's letter No. 342/2/50 of the 20th November to Passant, appears from the map to lie about 35 miles West of the Southern extremity of Sakhalin. It appears to be about 6 miles long by 3 miles broad. As regards the other "islands" mentioned by Research Department, the fact is that they do not appear on any of the maps, even those of quite a large scale, available to us. However, a member of the Diplomatic Section, who was in Japan in an unofficial capacity before the war and is one of the few persons we know who has visited Sakhalin, confirms that there are about 3 tiny uninhabited rocks off the East coast of Sakhalin, which he has himself seen. They are used, he says, as seal fisheries.

4. We are sending a copy of this letter to Tomlinson in Washington.

Yours ever,

CHANCERY.

Japan and Pacific Department,
Foreign Office,
London, S.W.1.

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United Kingdom Liaison Mission
in Japan,
British Embassy,
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